

Korea Battery

LGES wins 2.9GWh Google ESS project; SK On wins 13% of Korea AI ESS tender

On 15 July, Yonhap reported that LGES will supply ESS to Google's solar-plus-storage project aimed at meeting growing electricity demand from its datacenter and other projects. This will use LGES's Gen 2 LFP ESS battery system. Meanwhile, the Korea government has awarded its first AI-powered ESS tender of 640 MWh to the K-battery trio. We note that the announcement of the 3rd Korea ESS central tender (potentially ~3.2 Gwh) is now expected in September. We view these developments as a minor positive for K-battery, with investor focus largely on profit turnaround OR repurposing/sale/monetization of unutilized battery assets as opposed to mere order wins. We prefer battery cell > battery materials, and recently moved SK Innovation to our top pick within K-energy after its >140% underperformance vs S-Oil, and 150%/13% underperformance vs SDI/LGES since 2Q25.

- LGES to supply 2.9GWh ESS system to Google:** On 15 Jul, [Yonhap](#) reported LGES's ESS supply partnership with Google and Cypress Creek Energy on building the Steel River Energy Center, a 2.46GW solar+storage project in Mississippi, Arkansas. Steel River is the US's largest solar+storage project to date with 2.94GWh of designed battery storage capacity. The project will proceed with a phase-based construction approach, with 2.0GWh of initial storage capacity, then expand to 2.9GWh when fully operational by 2029. Google, as both an anchor investor and offtaker, will support the development of the first two phases of the project. LGES is reportedly planning to supply its Gen II LFP ESS battery system, JF2 DC Link. Unveiled last September, JF2 DC Link features LGES's proprietary safety-reinforced pack and system design, which satisfies the stringent requirements on thermal runaway propagation mitigation from North American operators, including UL9540A and Large-Scale Fire Testing (LSFT).
- SDI/LGES/SK Inno won 66%/22%/13% of 640MWh Korea AI ESS project.** According to [local media](#), Samsung SDI/LGES/ SK Inno have secured 420MWh/140MWh/80MWh of ESS battery orders from Korea's first government-led, AI-powered distribution grid ESS project. The "2026 AI-powered ESS deployment support project" featured 640MWh ESS, and was awarded to a consortium of nine operators including LGES, HD Electric, Hyundai E&C, SK Eternix and more. LGES won the largest order (140MWh) as a single operator, while Samsung SDI will supply NCA ESS battery cells to 6/9 operators. SK On won 80MWh, i.e. 13% of the total tender. The third batch of KPX central ESS orders is expected to be announced in September, which industry observers believe might be bigger than the first and second tenders (Figure 1).
- Ultium Tennessee started LFP ESS supply, Warren EV plant set for August restart:** On 10 Jul, GM Authority reported that the Ultium plant has begun production of LFP ESS battery cells at its Spring Hill, Tennessee facility. The plant will supply Gen II LFP batteries to LGES Vertech, LGES's US ESS system integration subsidiary (100% owned). The GM-LGES Ultium JV has been offline for 6 months for ESS line conversion, with current progress in-line with LGES' guided timeline of a 3Q re-start. Ultium Tennessee's original NCMA Gen I cell capacity has been consolidated to the Warren, Ohio plant, which is set to return in Aug 2026. LGES's 1H26 ESS production has lagged

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expectations due to production bottlenecks, but we note LGES recently completed onboarding of a second company for ESS packaging, and we expect production bottlenecks to be largely alleviated in 2H ([JPM note](#)). We forecast LGES'S US ESS shipment volume doubling from 10.6 Gwh in 1H, to 19.4 Gwh in 2H, with economies of scale helping the company move towards breakeven-ex-AMPC by 4Q26.

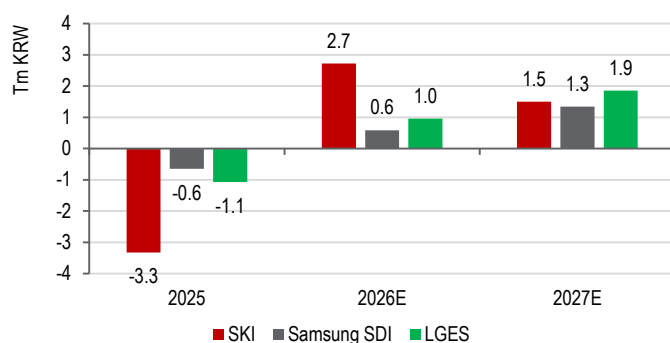
- **SK Inno to book highest FY26-27 NP amongst K-Battery trio due to lubricant/refining tailwinds?** We recently [reshuffled](#) our top picks within the K-energy space to SK Inno heading into 2Q print on expectations of a strong beat from lubricant/refining earnings (JPMe 77% above consensus). SK Inno has underperformed its peer refiners YTD (+198% vs S-Oil +74%, FPCC +6%), largely due to its battery drag (Figure 2). We [initiated coverage of SK Inno at OW](#) in May as we see favorable risk-reward as the company has halted its cash burn on batteries, is selling/optimizing battery assets, and looks set to deliver multi-year high earnings due to refining and lubricant strength (Figure 3). Re-iterate OW.

Figure 1: Korea ESS tender result summary

Round	Tender announce date	Result announce/news date	Contract volume	Installation deadline	Results		
					Samsung SDI	LGES	SK On
#1	5/22/2025	7/25/2025 (targeted for mid-Jul)	540MW/3,240MWh (6hr duration)	Dec-26	2,574MWh (79%); NCA battery ESS for 6 of 8 tendered facilities	666MWh (21%); LFP battery for Gwangyang/Jeju facility	n/a
#2	11/27/2025	2/12/2026 (targeted for mid-Feb)	540MW/3,240MWh (6 hr duration)	Dec-27	1212MWh (35.7%)	1212MWh (35.7%); one out of 7 sites captured	1,704 MWh (53%); LFP battery for three selected facility across South Jeolla/Jeju
AI-based ESS construction support project					420MWh (66.1%); 21 of 32 distribution lines captured	140MWh (21.8%)	80MWh (12.5%)
#3 Set for September							
Combined tender volume (GWh)			7.12		4.2	2.0	1.8
Korea Government FYP ESS installation target by 2035			25				

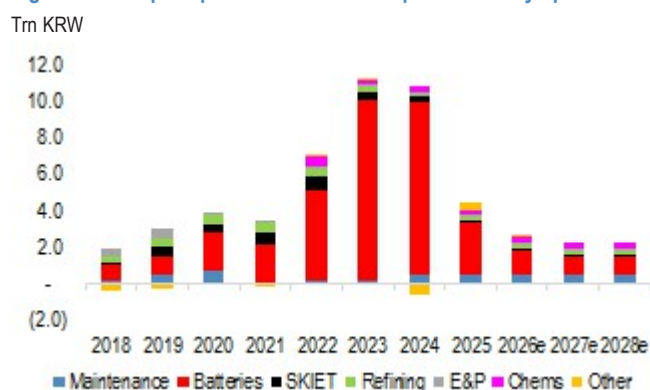
Source: Media reports, Korea Power Exchange, J.P. Morgan Asia Energy Research

Figure 2: FY26-27 NP of K-battery names (Trn KRW)



Source: J.P. Morgan estimates

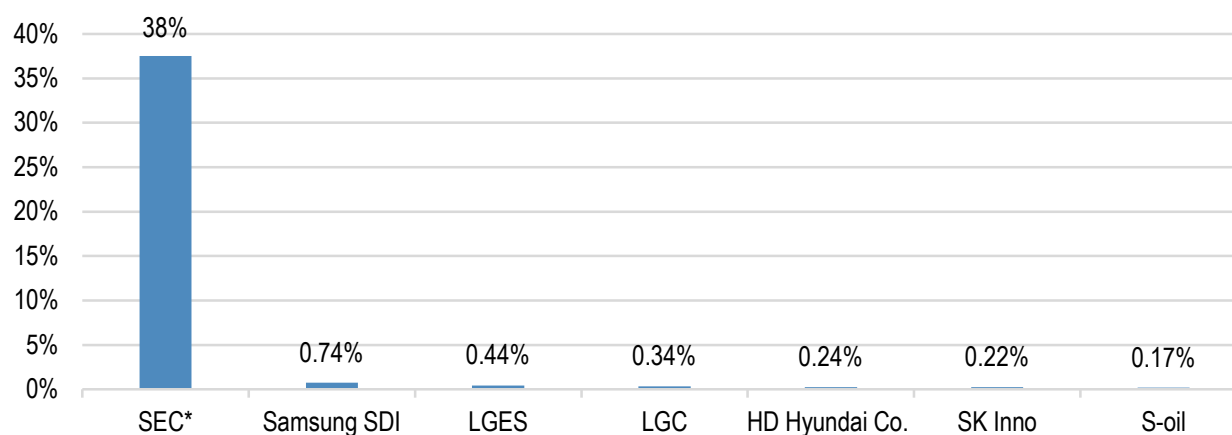
Figure 3: Sharp drop in SK Innovation capex as battery spend falls



Source: Company data, J.P. Morgan estimates

Figure 4: MSCI Korea index weightage for selected names

as of 17 Jul 2026



Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P., J.P. Morgan. *: Includes both ordinary share and preferred share weightage.

Figure 5: Share price performance of selected refining/chemicals names since 2021

Re-based to 100

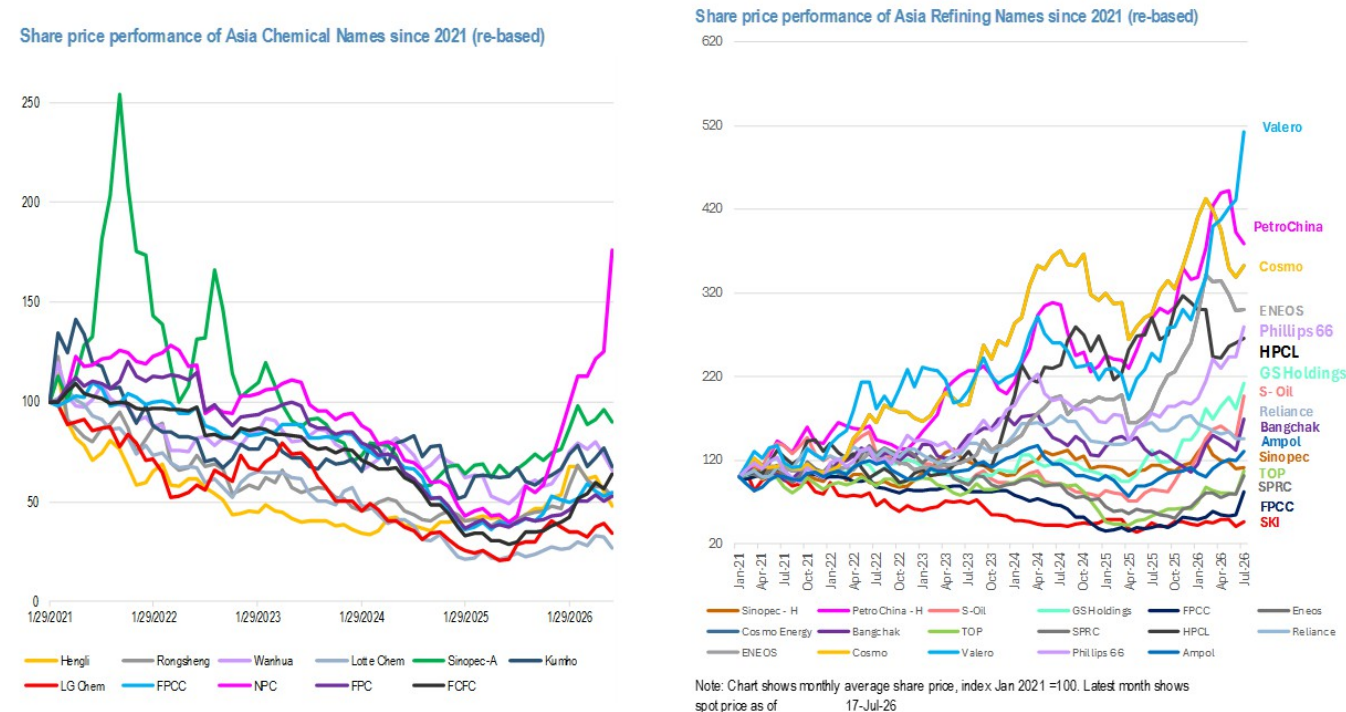


Figure 6: Monthly EV shipment trend

Country	EV type	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25	Jan-26	Feb-26	Mar-26	Apr-26	May-26	Jun-26	2024	2025	2026
Germany	BEV	47,163	48,614	39,367	45,495	52,425	55,741	54,774	42,692	46,275	70,663	64,350	59,969	84,057	380,609	545,142	368,006
	PHEV	25,608	27,197	23,973	27,685	30,946	32,433	30,259	21,790	24,328	29,996	27,546	27,921	32,212	191,905	311,398	163,793
	Total	72,771	75,811	63,340	73,180	83,371	88,174	85,033	64,482	70,603	100,659	91,896	87,890	116,269	572,514	856,540	531,799
UK	BEV	47,354	29,825	21,969	72,779	36,830	39,965	47,139	29,654	21,840	86,120	39,084	43,931	63,950	381,970	473,348	284,579
	PHEV	21,382	17,489	9,803	38,308	17,601	18,005	16,898	18,557	10,438	49,671	20,597	22,167	26,702	167,178	225,143	148,132
	Total	68,736	47,314	31,772	111,087	54,431	57,970	64,037	48,211	32,278	135,791	59,681	66,098	90,652	549,148	698,491	432,711
France	BEV	28,858	19,547	16,992	31,349	34,108	34,383	42,211	30,307	35,683	49,735	36,216	37,421	55,851	290,608	326,923	245,213
	PHEV	11,784	8,415	5,855	9,118	9,323	9,515	17,272	4,821	6,980	8,216	8,333	7,648	12,300	146,392	108,627	48,298
	Total	40,642	27,962	22,847	40,467	43,431	43,898	59,483	35,128	42,663	57,951	44,549	45,069	68,151	437,000	435,550	293,511
Italy	BEV	7,973	5,864	3,298	7,169	6,280	15,266	12,104	9,423	12,483	16,137	13,238	13,724	14,894	65,620	94,704	79,899
	PHEV	9,528	8,742	4,669	10,670	9,086	8,664	9,835	11,638	12,610	16,998	14,184	15,164	15,723	51,852	96,456	86,317
	Total	17,501	14,606	7,967	17,839	15,366	23,930	21,939	21,061	25,093	33,135	27,422	28,888	30,617	117,472	191,160	166,216
Spain	BEV	11,243	8,691	7,032	10,110	9,065	9,316	11,179	6,472	10,181	13,125	11,039	13,434	14,224	57,377	104,507	68,475
	PHEV	13,533	12,311	7,907	10,369	12,622	11,999	12,682	8,740	12,793	15,830	13,922	14,868	15,567	58,551	125,108	81,720
	Total	24,776	21,002	14,939	20,479	21,687	21,315	23,861	15,212	22,974	28,955	24,961	28,302	29,791	115,928	229,615	150,195
EU5	BEV	142,591	112,541	88,658	166,902	138,708	154,671	167,407	118,548	126,462	235,780	163,927	168,479	232,976	1,176,184	1,544,624	1,046,172
	PHEV	81,835	74,154	52,207	96,150	79,578	80,616	86,946	65,546	67,149	120,711	84,582	87,768	102,504	615,878	866,732	528,260
	EU5 total	224,426	186,695	140,865	263,052	218,286	235,287	254,353	184,094	193,611	356,491	248,509	256,247	335,480	1,792,062	2,411,356	1,574,432
China	BEV	660,000	607,000	690,000	832,000	810,000	827,000	782,000	348,000	278,000	568,000	505,270	637,000	685,000	6,320,413	7,869,960	3,021,270
	PHEV	451,000	380,000	425,000	466,000	472,000	494,000	555,000	248,000	186,000	280,000	271,000	313,000	322,000	4,584,924	4,842,131	1,620,000
	China total	1,111,000	987,000	1,115,000	1,298,000	1,282,000	1,321,000	1,337,000	596,000	464,000	848,000	776,270	950,000	1,007,000	10,905,337	12,712,091	4,641,270
USA	BEV (MI)	100,792	130,270	148,557	147,398	72,408	69,054	86,668	65,725	70,545	83,883	78,409	86,495	73,014	1,306,537	1,270,541	458,072
	PHEV (MI)	20,955	24,137	29,971	24,676	11,546	12,671	14,281	9,938	11,225	13,218	15,043	18,728	17,633	316,610	292,682	85,785
	Total (MI)	121,747	154,407	178,528	172,074	83,954	81,725	100,949	75,663	81,771	97,101	93,452	105,223	90,647	1,623,147	1,563,223	543,857
Canada	BEV+PHEV	14,015	13,916	14,643	17,101	14,653	14,199	15,995	8,672	12,626	21,574	17,795			264,277	169,972	60,667
% m/m																	
EU5		21%	-17%	-25%	87%	-17%	8%	8%	-28%	5%	84%	-30%	3%	31%			
China		9%	-11%	13%	16%	-1%	3%	1%	-55%	-22%	83%	-8%	22%				
US (MI)		-9%	27%	16%	-4%	-51%	-3%	24%	-25%	8%	19%	-4%	13%	-14%			
% y/y																	
EU5		23%	44%	48%	39%	46%	42%	35%	30%	36%	46%	43%	38%	49%	-4%	35%	-14%
China		30%	12%	9%	16%	7%	4%	3%	-20%	-32%	-6%	-15%	-7%		41%	17%	-14%
US (MI)		-7%	14%	19%	38%	-37%	-44%	-40%	-40%	-35%	-35%	-31%	-21%	-26%	12%	-4%	-65%
															2024	2025	2Q26
Sum of above BEV		903,383	849,811	927,215	1,146,300	1,021,116	1,050,725	1,036,075	532,273	475,007	887,663	747,606	891,974	990,990	8,803,134	10,685,125	4,525,514
		24%	26%	21%	31%	16%	6%	2%	-13%	-23%	-3%	-4%	8%	10%	16%	21%	-3%
Sum of above PHEV		553,790	478,291	507,178	586,826	563,124	587,287	656,227	323,484	264,374	413,929	370,625	419,496	442,137	5,517,412	6,001,545	2,234,045
		25%	3%	1%	5%	-6%	-1%	3%	-19%	-20%	9%	-16%	-19%	-20%	59%	22%	-15%

Source: Various auto industry association, J.P. Morgan Asia Energy Research

Related Research

[Korea Energy: 2Q likely to beat on lubricants, with W4.2trn refiner compensation fund a 4Q tailwind; retain OW, but change pecking order to SK Inno > S-Oil \(12 Jul 2026\)](#)

[LG Energy Solution: 2Q26 broadly in-line, though ESS production bottlenecks remain; look towards a more meaningful 2H recovery in core earnings \(7 Jul 2026\)](#)

[Korea Battery: Share prices +10-26% on hopes of accelerated US AIDC infrastructure buildout; raise US ESS demand estimate by 52% \(29 Jun 2026\)](#)

[SK Innovation: Battery overhang priced in; one of Asia's most undervalued integrated energy platforms; initiate at OW \(14 May 2026\)](#)

[LG Energy Solution: Oracle AIDC order just 1 of many. Datacenters to form 18% of US ESS demand by 2032 \(28 May 2026\)](#)

[LG Energy Solution: Guiding an improved 2Q outlook. Launching Gen 3 power grid project by 2028, with reported >100 Gwh BMW cylindrical order win \(30 Apr 2026\)](#)

Companies Discussed in This Report (all prices in this report as of market close on 16 July 2026, unless otherwise indicated)
LG Energy Solution(373220.KS/W332,000/OW), S-Oil Corp(010950.KS/W143,800/OW), SK Innovation(096770.KS/W120,300/OW), Samsung SDI(006400.KS/W430,000/OW)

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LG Energy Solution (373220.KS, 373220 KS) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (W)	Price Target (W)
26-Oct-23	OW	409500	570,000
25-Jan-24	OW	380500	475,000
23-Apr-24	OW	378500	430,000
28-Jul-24	N	325000	330,000
08-Oct-24	N	420000	370,000
09-Nov-24	N	398500	340,000
09-Jul-25	OW	307000	360,000
27-Jul-25	OW	363500	420,000
27-Oct-25	OW	486500	580,000
24-Dec-25	OW	390000	500,000
09-Jan-26	OW	369500	430,000
08-Feb-26	OW	389500	450,000
22-Apr-26	OW	488000	510,000
30-Apr-26	OW	473000	530,000
07-Jul-26	OW	354500	430,000

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Apr 21, 2022. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

S-Oil Corp (010950.KS, 010950 KS) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (W)	Price Target (W)
30-Jul-23	OW	72900	85,000
04-Nov-24	OW	58100	71,000
26-Jan-25	N	60700	60,000
27-Jul-25	UW	62300	52,000
03-Nov-25	UW	72000	60,000
27-Jan-26	UW	98500	71,000
12-May-26	OW	111200	135,000
12-Jul-26	OW	131900	145,000

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Jul 31, 2002. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

Samsung SDI (006400.KS, 006400 KS) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (W)	Price Target (W)
28-Jul-23	OW	662000	1,000,000
19-Oct-23	OW	512000	850,000
12-Dec-23	OW	446000	600,000
31-Jan-24	OW	374500	550,000
31-Jul-24	OW	330500	400,000
07-Oct-24	OW	361500	450,000
16-Mar-25	N	191400	210,000
25-Apr-25	N	184700	200,000
29-Oct-25	N	309000	330,000
02-Mar-26	N	468000	400,000
30-Mar-26	OW	398500	650,000
24-Apr-26	OW	634000	720,000
28-Apr-26	OW	638000	770,000
14-Jul-26	OW	450000	630,000

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Jul 23, 2003. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

SK Innovation (096770.KS, 096770 KS) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price (W)	Price Target (W)
03-Nov-23	OW	127600	180,000
07-Feb-24	OW	120800	145,000
23-Apr-24	OW	110600	120,000
05-Sep-24	NR	107000	--
14-May-26	OW	129600	165,000
12-Jul-26	OW	103900	170,000

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
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Break in coverage Apr 24, 2026 - May 14, 2026.

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